ERA 17

# The Second New Deal & Its Critics

*1935 – 1939*

Social Security · labor rights · critics · legacy

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

How did the Second New Deal reshape America—and why did it face fierce opposition?

**KEY TERMS**

The Social Security Act · the Wagner Act · court-packing · the New Deal coalition

**ALIGNED TO**

CED Topic 7.10 · AMSCO Ch. 7.10

A BOLDER PUSH, 1935

# The Second New Deal

# Security for All



- The **Social Security Act** (1935) created old-age pensions and unemployment insurance.
- It also aided the disabled and dependent children.
- For the first time, the federal government guaranteed a **safety net**.

# The Second New Deal

I

## Social Security

Pensions and unemployment insurance—a permanent **safety net**.

II

## The Wagner Act

Guaranteed workers the right to unionize and bargain collectively (**NLRB**).

III

## Jobs & Wages

The **WPA** employed millions; the **Fair Labor Standards Act** set a minimum wage.

SECTION

# Critics & Conflict

# Critics of the New Deal

## From the Left

'Not enough!'

- **Huey Long's 'Share Our Wealth'** promised to tax the rich and give to all.
- Radio priest **Father Coughlin** attacked bankers and capitalism.
- They demanded a far more radical redistribution of wealth.

## From the Right

'Too much!'

- The **American Liberty League** and business leaders cried 'socialism.'
- They warned the New Deal destroyed free enterprise and self-reliance.
- The **Supreme Court** struck down the NRA and AAA as unconstitutional.

# The Court-Packing Fight

- Frustrated by the Court striking down New Deal laws, FDR proposed adding up to six justices.
- Critics called it a dangerous power grab—'**court-packing**.'
- The plan failed and cost FDR political support, even within his own party.



Aftermath

The Washington Post

The Weather

NO. 22,150 WASHINGTON: SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 6, 1937 THREE CENTS

## Roosevelt Asks 6 New High Court Judges

### G. M. Accord With 'Stay-In' Strikers Near, Murphy Says

Governor and Roosevelt Talk by Phone; Parley Resumes Today.

Writ for Arrest Of Martin Issued

Flint Sheriff Asks for National Guard Aid in Eviction.

### 'Mother India' Author Lashes Child Marriage

MISS KATHERINE MAYO.

Urges Public Opinion to Stamp Out 'Debasing Offense' in U. S.

### Six Believed Dead in Blast At Louisville

12 Hurt as Explosions, Fire Raze 2 Buildings in Business Area.

Flood Seen as Cause of Disaster, Third in 24 Hours.

### *Shakeup Plan Provides Additions As Federal Jurists Pass Age of 70*

Surprise Move Splits Congress; Majority Noncommittal.

Hoover Vehement In Condemnation

House Judiciary Body Is Cool; Democrats Plan Swift Action.

By Robert C. Albright.

### *Elders of Congress to Pass On Fate of Elders of Court*

Opinion Divided With Glass Declaring 'Some Over 70 Are Fit, Some Younger Aren't Fit for Anything.'

(Pictures on Page 7.)

Message From President Accompanied by Letter From Attorney General Deploring Delays in Justice.

*PROCTOR URGED TO ADVISE CHIEF JUSTICE ON DOCKETS*

Executive Would Name New District Judges Despite Present Vacancies; One Existing More Than a Year.

*You Will Want to Read—*

# The New Deal's Legacy—and Limits

I

## A Bigger Government

It built a lasting **welfare state** and an activist federal government.

II

## A New Coalition

The **New Deal coalition** realigned American politics for a generation.

III

## Real Limits

It excluded many farm and domestic workers—hitting Black Americans and women—and never fully ended the Depression. **WWII** did.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

# The Second New Deal & Its Critics

1. The **Second New Deal** built a lasting safety net—the **Social Security Act**, the **Wagner Act**, and the **WPA**.

2. Critics attacked from the **left** (**Huey Long**, Coughlin) and the **right** (the **Liberty League**, the **Supreme Court**).

3. FDR's **court-packing** plan backfired, but the New Deal permanently expanded government and forged the **New Deal coalition**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

# The Second New Deal & Its Critics

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

**CAUSATION**

Explain how the **Social Security Act** and **Wagner Act** permanently expanded the federal government.

**COMPARISON**

Compare the New Deal's critics on the **left** and the **right**. What did each fear?

**ARGUMENTATION**

Did the New Deal **save** American capitalism, **transform** it, or fall short? Make a claim.

Up next — **Class 48: World War II** (the road to war & Pearl Harbor)